

Kevin Jacobson was billing for a reply brief when Stephanie Hovhannisyan (a lower biller) did the work on the opening brief. On actual Reply, that moved to Derek Chipman, who billed 4.3 hours rather than the 5.3 anticipated. The actual time spent is somewhat more reasonable than anticipated, although still more than required given that Honda's opposition was relatively standard and the Court is aware that much of this work is repeated case-by-case. While counsel must certainly make sure to cite accurate cases, the nature of the briefing suggests that 0.8 to review the brief, 0.7 to review the declaration, 0.6 to research and 2.0 to draft includes overlapping and duplicative work on top of likely previously written work product. The Court would be surprised if preparation for and appearance at the hearing will be 2 hours, especially since the parties may waive hearing. The Court therefore reduces the Reply work, including the hearing, to 4.3 *total* hours, at \$495 per hour, which is \$2,128.50, instead of \$4,000.

Honda also challenges time spent on written discovery requests, noting the templated nature of these requests. Oilva fails to rebut this issue, noting only the quantity of requests. By way of example, it is unimpressive to the Court to note that 0.3 hours were spent on the declaration of necessity, a document that is routinely drafted in almost every single civil case and contains very little new substance. This is indication that counsel has overbilled for templated work. The Court will reduce the hours on written discovery from 3 to 1.5, resulting in a reduction of \$600.

Plaintiffs have adequately supported their need for and work on the deposition subpoena relating to the servicing dealership in this case, and the Court will grant the requested hours.

While Plaintiffs have shown that there was work and back-and-forth on the deposition of Honda's Person Most Qualified, they have failed to show that the hours claimed are reasonable. While Honda attached documents showing that the work did not appear original, Oilva attached no rebuttal to this argument. The Court will reduce Ryan Ardi's hours on this task from 6.2 to 4.9, resulting in a reduction of \$1,027.

Finally, while Honda served duplicative notices on Plaintiffs, that does not mean the work to respond to those was unique or required the time requested. The Court will reduce the hours on this task from 2.3 to 1.1, resulting in a reduction of \$474.

The Court therefore grants attorney's fees in the amount of \$12,021.50.

12. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C25-00518
CASE NAME: MARIO GUATEMALA VS. MUHAMMAD ASHRAF
MOTION TO BE RELIEVED AS COUNSEL RE CALIFORNIA WHEELS & TIRES LLC.
FILED BY: CALIFORNIA WHEELS & TIRES LLC., A CALIFORNIA LIMITED LIABILITY COMPANY
TENTATIVE RULING:

Good cause shown, the Motion to Be Relieved as Counsel is **granted**.